

Where Should a New Cafe Open in Kadikoy?

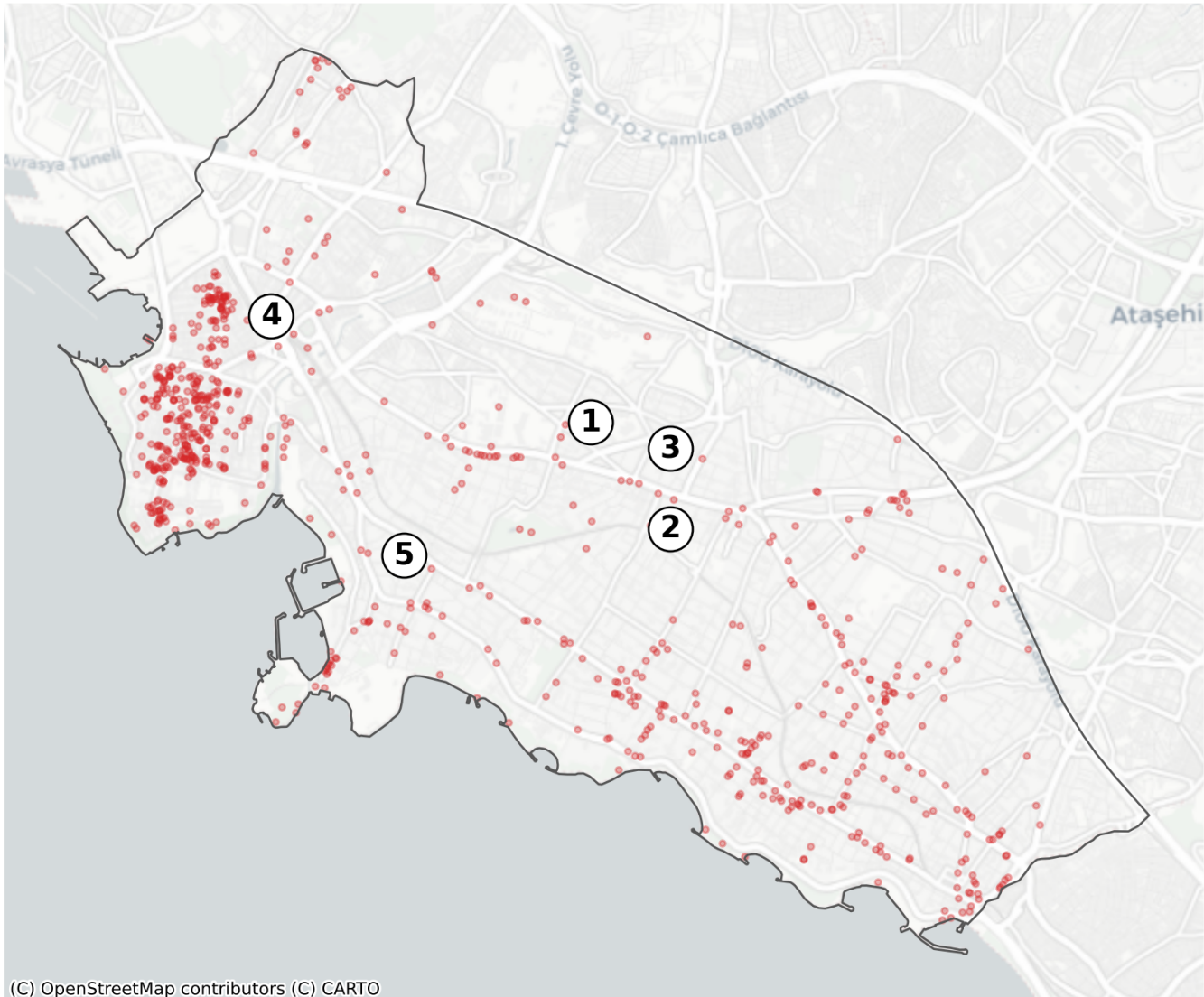
A data-driven site-selection analysis | Istanbul, Turkey

The question

Kadikoy already has 744 cafes. The goal was not to find empty space, but to find unmet demand: locations with real foot traffic that existing cafes have not yet captured. I scored 626 candidate sites on live OpenStreetMap data across two signals - local demand and competition.

Recommended sites

Recommended café sites in Kadıköy

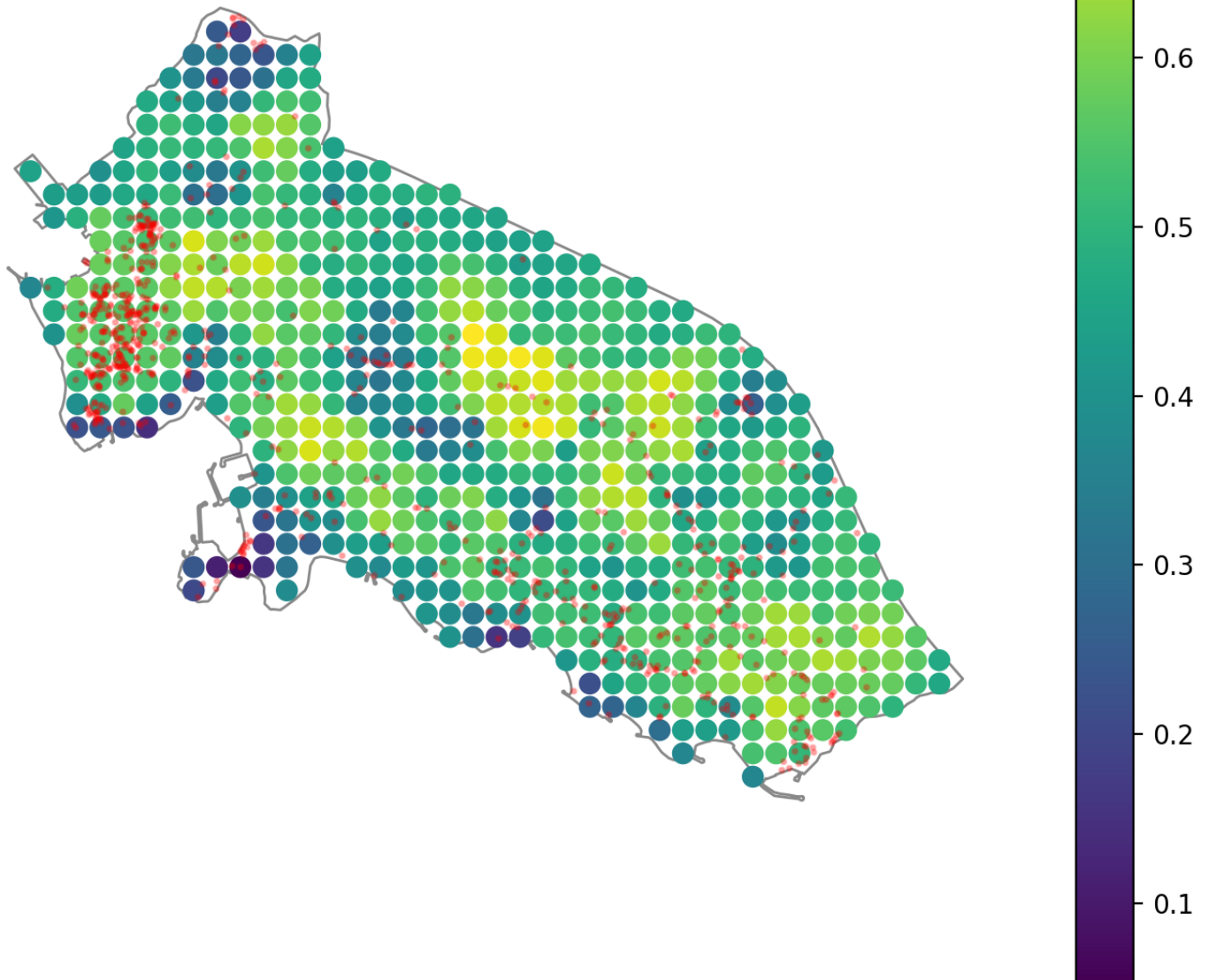


What the model found

- The strongest sites sit just inland of the saturated Moda waterfront - enough activity to sustain a cafe, with fewer rivals than the coast.
- Site 1 is the balanced pick: solid demand, below-average competition.
- Site 4 has the district's highest footfall, but more competition - the choice for an operator confident they can compete on quality.
- Site 3 is the lowest-risk option: fewer customers, but the emptiest market.

The opportunity surface

Café site suitability (yellow = best) · red = existing cafés



Method

Demand was estimated from everyday activity (shops, transit, services) within a 5-minute walk - a proxy used because open census data was not available at this resolution. Competition was modeled as distance-decay pressure from existing cafes. Scores were normalized by percentile rank and weighted 55% demand / 45% low-competition. Tools: Python, OSMnx, GeoPandas, NetworkX.

Have a market in mind? I can run this on any city or business type.

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